

Weleetka Negro Killed Following Scuffle Over 50c

Archie Tamplain Held In Death of O'Neal

An argument over fifty cents resulted in the slaying of J. C. O'Neal, 42, by Archie Tamplain, 34, both Weleetka negroes.

Assistant County Attorney Odie Webb today said Tamplain is still incoherent, and no charges have been filed as yet.

The killing was preceded an hour by a brief scuffle with O'Neal brandishing a knife, and Tamplain a four-foot pipe. O'Neal was wounded with a single blast from a .22 automatic rifle at 2:30 Sunday morning.

The shooting took place in front of Johnie Hall's house in Weleetka after Tamplain and O'Neal returned with ten other negroes from a drinking foray in Clearview. The knife-pipe scuffle took place in the Clearview tavern of L. G. Carson. Carson ordered the two out, and they started back to Weleetka.

Alighting in front of Hall's house Tamplain went inside and returned with the gun. One of the negroes yelled "Look out, he has a gun," and O'Neal wrestled for the gun. One shot went off and struck O'Neal in the left breast.

He was immediately rushed to the Okfuskee county hospital. He died at 8:30 Monday morning. Harl Stokes, hospital administrator, said O'Neal's body was taken to Okmulgee today for an autopsy.

County authorities have not indicated the charges to be filed. A sanity hearing may be held for the alleged murder.

